MIT ZARAGOZA
International Logistics Program

MZ505 Inventory Systems 2026/2027

Assignment #3

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- **Individual Assignment**
- **Due: Oct 13th (Tue): 08.30 AM**
- **Please submit you work online via Canvas (only one .pdf file).**

Problem 1 (Max Points 35)

Weekly demand for Vespa (Scooters) at a retail store in Zaragoza is normally distributed, with a mean of 15 and a standard deviation of 7. As this is the only Vespa retailer in Aragon, any unmet demand is backordered. The store manager follows a periodic review policy with an inventory review period of one week and targets for a customer service level (CSL or in-stock probability) of 90%. The manufacturer of Vespa currently takes three weeks to fill an order. The store operates 52 weeks per year.

(a) What should the store's order-up-to (OUT) level be? (5 points)

(b) What is the expected backorder? (5 points)

(c) What is the expected on-order inventory? (Recall, your on-order inventory is also called pipeline inventory). (5 points)

(d) What is the expected on-hand inventory? (5 points)

(e) What fill rate (FR) does the store achieve? (5 points)

(f~g) The purchasing cost is €2,000 per vehicle, while the store manager has estimated that the penalty per unit backordered is €250 and the annual inventory carrying cost is around 25%.

(f) If the manager wishes to minimize holding and backorder penalty costs, what should be her target in-stock probability (CSL)? (5 points)

(g) What should its OUT level be in this case? (5 points)

Problem 2 (Max Points 30)

You are the owner of an online book retail store named RosaPanter.com. Consider your inventory of a bestseller book called "The wisdom of crowds" by James Surowiecki. You order the book from an oversea printing office with a shipping lead time of four weeks and you order weekly. Average quarterly demand is normally distributed with a mean of 415 books and standard deviation of 154 books. The holding cost per book per week is $0.75. You estimate that your backorder penalty cost is $50 per book backordered. Assume there are 4.33 weeks per month. (Note: Consider one quarter having 13 weeks)

(a) Suppose your order up-to (OUT) level is 400 books. After receiving your weekly delivery from your supplier at the beginning of a week you note that have 150 books on-hand and 120 books still on-order. How many books will you order this week? (5 points)

(b) Suppose your OUT level is 500 books. What is your expected on-order inventory in books? Round to the closest integer. (5 points)

(c) If you wish to minimize inventory holding costs while maintaining a 99.25% in-stock probability, then what should your OUT level be? (5 points)

(d) If you wish to minimize inventory holding costs while maintaining a 99.25% fill rate, then what should your OUT level be? (5 points)

(e) If you wish to minimize holding and backorder penalty costs, then what should your OUT level be? (5 points)

(f) Now consider your inventory of another book called "A Culture of Conspiracy: Apocalyptic Visions in Contemporary America" written by Michael Barkun, (a much less popular book). RosaPanter.com will order the book from a local printing office daily and the printing office delivers book with a lead time of 2 days. Average demand has a Poisson distribution with mean 1.0 book per day. The holding cost per book per day is $0.05 and the backorder penalty cost is about $5 per book short. What is your optimal OUT level? (5 points)

Problem 3 (Max Points 15)

In the order up-to model, assume that the mean of demand in a period remains the same and the order up-to level is kept at a constant level. If the demand uncertainty –i.e., the standard deviation of demand in each period– increases, then

(i) The expected inventory at the end of each period would increase.

(ii) The expected inventory at the end of each period would decrease.

(iii) The expected inventory at the end of each period would remain unchanged.

(iv) The expected inventory at the end of each period may go up or down.

Please explain why. Please generalize your answer to any demand distribution (although you can assume normal distribution for gaining some insight).

Problem 4 (Max Points 20)

Motorola obtains cell phones from its contract manufacturer located in China to serve the US market from a warehouse located in Memphis, Tennessee. Daily demand at the Memphis warehouse is normally distributed, with a mean of 5,000 and a standard deviation of 2,500. The warehouse aims for a CSL of 97%. The company is debating whether to use sea or air transportation from China. Sea transportation results in a lead time of 36 days and costs $0.50 per phone. Air transportation results in a lead time of 4 days and costs $1.50 per phone. Each phone costs $100, and Motorola uses an annual holding cost of 20%. To begin with, assume that Motorola takes ownership of the inventory upon delivery. Given lot sizes by sea and air, Motorola would have to place an order every 20 days using sea transport but could order daily using air transport.

(a) Assume that Motorola follows a periodic review policy. What order-up-to (OUT) level and safety inventory should the warehouse aim for when using sea or air transportation? How many days of safety stock will Motorola carry under each policy? You can assume that E[backorder] = 0 in your calculation of safety stock. (8 points)

(b) How many days of cycle inventory does Motorola carry under each policy? (2 points)

(c) Under a periodic review policy, do you recommend sea or air transportation? Does your answer change if Motorola has ownership of the inventory while it is in transit? (10 points)

Quiz Problem (Max Points 20)

ACold Inc. is a frozen food distributor with 10 warehouses across the country. Iven Tory, one of the warehouse managers, wants to make sure that the inventory policies used by the warehouse are minimizing inventory while still maintaining quick delivery to ACold's customers. Since the warehouse carries hundreds of different products, Iven decided to study one. He picked the “peperoni special” from Caruso's Frozen Pizza (CFP). Demand for peperoni special averages 400 per day with a standard deviation of 150. Iven places his orders daily and orders from CFP arrive four days later. Further, it costs ACold $0.01 per day to keep a unit of pizza in inventory, while a back order is estimated to cost ACold $0.45 per unit.

(a) What base-stock level (i.e., order-up-to level) should Iven choose for CFPs if his goal is to minimize holding and backorder costs? (2 points)

(b) What base-stock level minimizes inventory while maintaining a 95% in-stock probability? (2 points)

(c) Suppose the base-stock level 2,800 is chosen. What is the annual holding cost assuming 260 days per year? Here, use the exact formula for safety stock. (6 points)

(d) After implementing a new managerial accounting system, Iven has realized that there is a fixed cost of $20 every time an order is placed with CFP. He wonders whether he can improve his overall costs by changing the frequency of placing orders with CFP (i.e., by changing the review period of CFP inventory), while targeting for an in-stock probability of 97%. He considers review periods of one, two, three, and four days as candidates. What would you recommend? How does your recommendation relate to the EOQ model’s recommendation? (10 points)